



SteadySense

An Intelligent Real-Time Elder Care Application

Privacy Policy

Version 1.0 | Last Updated: May 2026

Introduction

Welcome to SteadySense! Your privacy and data protection are of paramount importance to us. This Privacy Policy outlines how SteadySense collects, uses, discloses, and safeguards your information when you use our mobile application. Please read this policy carefully to understand our practices regarding your personal data.

1 Information We Collect

To provide our comprehensive elder care monitoring and life-saving features, SteadySense collects the following types of information:

1.1 Personal Information

- **Account Registration Data:** Full name, email address, and password (hashed and encrypted)
- **Authentication Information:** User credentials managed securely through Firebase Authentication
- **Account Role:** Whether you are registered as an Elder or Caretaker
- **Profile Information:** Optional profile picture and biographical information

1.2 Location Data

- **GPS Coordinates:** Precise latitude and longitude collected periodically during normal operation
- **Network-Based Location:** Approximate location based on WiFi and cellular networks
- **Emergency Location:** High-precision location data collected and shared during emergency events (falls or SOS alerts)
- **Location History:** Recent location points are temporarily stored for map rendering and navigation

1.3 Sensor Data

- **Accelerometer Data:** Continuous motion and impact data used to detect potential falls
- **Step Count Data:** Aggregated step information calculated from sensor inputs
- **Activity Recognition:** Device inactivity, rest periods, and activity transitions detected through sensor fusion
- **Simulated Biometric Data:** Simulated pulse and health metrics displayed for informational purposes

1.4 Audio Data

- **Voice Interactions:** Audio captured only when you interact with the Voice Assistant
- **Voice History:** Conversation summaries (not raw audio files) are recorded in your voice history
- **Processing:** Audio is processed by Google Gemini API for natural language understanding
- **Storage:** Raw audio recordings are not permanently stored; only conversation metadata is retained

1.5 Device Information

- **Device Identifiers:** Device model, OS version, and unique device identifiers
- **App Performance Data:** Crash logs and performance metrics for app improvement
- **Connectivity Information:** WiFi, mobile network, and internet connection status

1.6 Usage Information

- **Feature Usage:** Which features you use and how frequently
- **Emergency Event Logs:** Records of falls detected, SOS alerts triggered, and responses
- **Interaction Timestamps:** When you perform key actions within the app

2 How We Use Your Information

Your data is used strictly to provide the core functionality of SteadySense and ensure the safety of our users:

2.1 Primary Uses

- **Fall Detection:** Analyze accelerometer data to automatically detect potential falls and trigger emergency protocols
- **Emergency Alerts:** Send real-time notifications to designated caretakers when emergencies occur
- **Location Sharing:** Display current and emergency location information to linked caretakers
- **Health Monitoring:** Calculate and display step counts, activity status, and other health metrics
- **Voice Assistance:** Process voice commands and provide conversational AI responses
- **Account Management:** Manage user authentication, passwords, and account security

2.2 Secondary Uses

- **App Improvement:** Analyze usage patterns to enhance features and user experience
- **Error Fixing:** Diagnose and fix technical issues through crash reports and logs
- **Security Monitoring:** Detect fraudulent activity and protect user accounts
- **Legal Compliance:** Fulfill legal obligations and respond to lawful requests

3 Data Sharing and Third Parties

3.1 With Linked Caretakers

Your health data, activity information, and location are shared **only** with caretakers that you have explicitly linked to your account using a secure 6-digit identification system:

- Daily step count and activity status
- Current location and location history during emergencies
- Emergency alerts and their timestamps
- Health metrics and activity patterns
- You have full control to unlink caretakers at any time

3.2 Third-Party Service Providers

SteadySense integrates with the following third-party services, each operating under strict security protocols:

- **Google Firebase:** Database storage, authentication, and cloud services
- **Google Gemini API:** Voice processing and natural language understanding for the Voice Assistant
- **MapLibre GL:** Interactive map rendering and location visualization
- **Google Cloud Platform:** Infrastructure and data hosting

Note: These third-party providers have their own privacy policies. We do not share personal information

with them beyond what is necessary for service delivery. SteadySense does not sell or rent your data to marketing agencies or data brokers.

3.3 Data Not Shared

- Your password is never shared with anyone, including support staff
- Raw voice audio recordings are not stored or shared
- Financial information is not collected or stored
- Medical records beyond activity data are not accessed

4 Data Security

4.1 Encryption

- **In Transit:** All data transmitted between your device and our servers is encrypted using TLS/SSL protocols
- **At Rest:** Data stored on Firebase is encrypted using industry-standard AES-256 encryption
- **Authentication:** Passwords are hashed using secure hashing algorithms and never stored in plain text

4.2 Access Control

- Access to user data is restricted to authorized personnel only
- Staff members receive training on data protection and privacy practices
- Access logs are maintained for security auditing

4.3 Security Measures

- Regular security audits and penetration testing
- Firewalls and intrusion detection systems
- Multi-factor authentication for staff access
- Automated backups with encrypted redundancy

4.4 Limitations

While we implement comprehensive security measures, no system is completely secure. We cannot guarantee absolute protection against unauthorized access, and you use the service at your own risk. Always keep your password secure and report any suspicious activity immediately.

5 Permissions Explained

SteadySense requires the following permissions to function properly:

5.1 Location Permissions (Foreground & Background)

- **Purpose:** Essential for tracking your location during emergencies and monitoring daily activities
- **Usage:** Location is collected every 30 seconds during normal operation; continuously during emergency events
- **Why Background:** To continue location tracking even when the app is minimized
- **Your Control:** You can disable location in Android settings, but emergency location sharing will not function

5.2 Activity Recognition / Sensor Permissions

- **Purpose:** Required to detect falls and calculate step counts
- **Usage:** Accelerometer data is analyzed continuously for impact detection
- **Your Control:** Disabling sensor access will prevent fall detection

5.3 Microphone Permission

- **Purpose:** Exclusively for the Voice Assistant feature
- **Usage:** Audio is captured only when you tap the microphone button
- **Storage:** Raw audio is not stored; only conversation summaries are retained
- **Your Control:** You can disable this permission if you do not use the Voice Assistant

5.4 Notification Permission

- **Purpose:** Essential for receiving emergency alerts and important system notifications
- **Usage:** Notifications are sent for falls detected, emergency alerts, and app updates
- **Your Control:** You can customize which notification types to receive in app settings

5.5 Contacts Permission (Optional)

- **Purpose:** Optional feature to quickly call emergency contacts
- **Usage:** Used only when you initiate a manual emergency call
- **Your Control:** Entirely optional; can be denied without affecting core functionality

6 Your Rights and Choices

6.1 Access and Portability

You have the right to:

- Request a copy of all personal data we hold about you
- Export your data in a portable format
- Request through the app's **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Request Data Export**

6.2 Correction and Deletion

You have the right to:

- Update or correct inaccurate information in your profile
- Request deletion of your account and associated data
- Account deletion is permanent and cannot be undone
- Access through **Settings** → **Account** → **Delete Account**

6.3 Withdrawal of Consent

You can:

- Revoke app permissions at any time through Android settings
- Disable the monitoring service while keeping your account active
- Unlink caretakers to stop data sharing with specific individuals
- Note: Disabling location or sensors will prevent emergency features from functioning

6.4 Opt-Out Options

- Stop sharing location updates: **Settings** → **Location Sharing** → Toggle Off
- Disable fall detection: **Settings** → **Monitoring** → Toggle Off
- Clear voice history: **Settings** → **Privacy** → **Clear Voice History**
- Disable analytics: **Settings** → **Analytics** → Toggle Off

7 Children's Privacy

SteadySense is designed for elderly individuals and their caretakers. The app is not intended for children under 13 years of age. We do not knowingly collect personal information from children under 13. If

we become aware that a child under 13 has provided us with personal information, we will promptly delete such information and terminate the child’s account.

If you believe a child under 13 has registered an account, please contact us immediately.

8 Data Retention

8.1 Active Accounts

While your account is active, we retain:

- All personal account information indefinitely
- Location history for the past 30 days (older data is automatically deleted)
- Emergency event logs indefinitely for your records
- Voice history indefinitely (unless you manually clear it)

8.2 Deleted Accounts

Upon account deletion:

- All personal data is permanently deleted from active databases within 30 days
- Backup copies are retained for 90 days for disaster recovery purposes
- After 90 days, all data is completely destroyed
- This action is irreversible

8.3 Legal and Security Holds

We may retain data longer if required by law or for legitimate security purposes, such as fraud investigation or legal proceedings.

9 International Data Transfers

SteadySense operates on Google Firebase, which may store your data across multiple geographic regions. By using SteadySense, you consent to the transfer of your data to countries outside your country of residence. These countries may have different data protection laws, but Google implements standard contractual clauses to ensure adequate data protection.

10 Policy Changes

We may update this Privacy Policy periodically to reflect changes in our practices, technology, legal requirements, or other factors. When we make material changes, we will notify you by:

- Posting the updated policy in the app with a “New Update” indicator
- Sending an email notification to your registered email address
- Requiring you to accept the new policy before continuing to use the app

Your continued use of SteadySense after changes are posted constitutes your acceptance of the updated Privacy Policy. We encourage you to review this policy regularly.

11 Contact Us

If you have questions, concerns, or requests regarding this Privacy Policy or our privacy practices, please contact us:

SteadySense Privacy Team

Email: privacy@steadysense.com

In-App Support: **Settings → Help & Support → Report Privacy Concern**

We will respond to all privacy inquiries within 30 days.

12 Complaint Procedure

If you believe your privacy rights have been violated, you have the right to lodge a complaint with your regional data protection authority. For residents of the European Union, you can file a complaint with your local Data Protection Authority.

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